JAMES CHRISTOPHER WRIGHT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 12 years building scalable infrastructure and leading engineering teams in fast-moving tech environments. I've spent the last 8 years working primarily with cloud platforms and distributed systems, moving from individual contributor to staff-level roles where I shape technical strategy. I'm based in Manchester and focus on mentoring junior engineers while solving complex architectural problems.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

CloudScale Innovations

cloudscale.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Led the redesign of our core Kubernetes infrastructure, reducing deployment times by 65% and cutting infrastructure costs by 40% annually.

Established technical direction for a team of 8 engineers across multiple squads, conducting architecture reviews and defining coding standards that improved code quality metrics.

Mentored 5 engineers into senior-level positions through structured feedback and hands-on pair programming sessions on critical system components.

Championed the migration from monolithic services to microservices architecture, managing risks and ensuring zero downtime during the 18-month transition.

Senior Platform Engineer

DataFlow Systems Ltd

dataflowsystems.co.uk

Manchester, United Kingdom

July 2018 - February 2022

Designed and implemented a highly available message queuing system handling 2 million events per second, serving 40+ internal teams.

Built comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana that reduced mean time to detection for incidents from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Collaborated with security and compliance teams to implement encryption at rest and in transit across all platform services, achieving SOC 2 Type II certification.

Established incident response procedures and conducted blameless postmortems that identified systemic issues and prevented 12+ major outages.

Senior Software Engineer

Vertex Solutions

vertexsolutions.net

Manchester, United Kingdom

September 2015 - June 2018

Architected and delivered a real-time analytics platform processing 500GB of data daily, used by the product and business intelligence teams.

Optimized database query performance through indexing strategies and query rewriting, achieving a 70% reduction in p99 latencies for customer-facing reports.

Developed CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab that automated testing and deployment, reducing release cycle time from 2 weeks to 3 days.

Onboarded and trained 6 junior developers on backend systems design, debugging techniques, and production operations best practices.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, Distributed systems, System design

DevOps: Docker, Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Prometheus, Grafana

Other: Apache Kafka, Linux, Git, gRPC, REST APIs